

Unit: Beware of Greeks Bearing Gifts

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Lead-in Examples / 導入範例

1. When Judy brought me cupcakes after our fight last week, my first impulse was to beware of Greeks bearing gifts.
1. 當茱蒂在上週我們吵架後給我帶來杯子蛋糕時，我的第一反應是「無事獻殷勤，非奸即盜」(beware of Greeks bearing gifts，要小心帶來禮物的希臘人)。
2. Beware of Greeks bearing gifts! Casandra, who has been spreading rumors to all my friends, suddenly tries to take me out to lunch.
2. 要小心帶來禮物的希臘人！一直在向我所有朋友散布謠言的卡珊卓突然試圖請我吃午餐。

Meaning & Origin / 語義與起源

Meaning / 片語含義

Be skeptical of a present or kindness from an enemy. (Farlex Dictionary of Idioms)

對來自敵人的禮物或善意保持懷疑。(法雷克斯俚語詞典)

Origin in the Trojan War / 特洛伊戰爭起源

This is originally a Latin phrase, coming from the story of the Trojan War. Near the end of the ten-year long Trojan War, the Greeks constructed a large wooden horse to pose as a peace offering to the Trojans. Laocoon, the Trojans priest, suspected that some menace had been hidden in the horse, and warned the Trojans not to accept the gift, crying, "Do not trust the horse, Trojans! Whatever it is, I fear the Achaeans, even when bringing gifts." However, after his warning, two sea serpents attacked Laocoon and his sons.

這最初是一個拉丁片語，源於特洛伊戰爭的故事。在長達十年的特洛伊戰爭即將結束時，希臘人建造了一匹巨大的木馬，作為向特洛伊人提供的和平祭品。特洛伊人的祭司拉奧孔懷疑木馬中隱藏著某種威脅，並警告特洛伊人不要接受這份禮物，他喊道：「不要相信這匹馬，特洛伊人！不論那是什麼，我都害怕希臘人，即使是在他們帶來禮物的時候。」然而，在他的警告之後，兩條海蛇襲擊了拉奧孔和他的兒子們。

The Trojans assumed it was a sign of Athena's displeasure and opened the gates and wheeled the horse within their walls. A celebratory victory festival was held; however, little did they know that the Greek soldiers had been hidden inside the horse belly and the Greeks crept out to open the city gates at night. Tens of thousands of Greek army had flocked to the city; then Troy was destroyed.

特洛伊人認為這是雅典娜不悅的象徵，於是打開城門，將木馬迎進了城牆之內。他們舉行了慶祝勝利的節日；然而，他們幾乎不知道希臘士兵已經隱藏在馬腹中，希臘人夜晚悄悄溜出來打開了城門。成千上萬的希臘軍隊湧入城市；隨後特洛伊被摧毀了。

Extended Content & Adaptations / 延伸內容與改編作品

Film: Troy (2004) / 電影：《特洛伊：木馬屠城》

Troy, a film published in 2004, was based on the epic poem by Homer, The Iliad, which described activities in the last couple of weeks of the decade-long Trojan War. The war centered around the most beautiful woman in the world, Helen of Sparta. After the event of judgement of Paris, the goddess Aphrodite kept her promise to make Helen fall in love with Paris and run off with him. Raged for Helen's leaving, Menelaus, king of Sparta, allied with his elder brother, Agamemnon, king of Mycenae. Making promise to get Helen back, they eventually grouped the Achaean army to invade Troy. The film ended with fall of Troy and a funeral held for Achilles (acted by Brad Pitt).

2004 年發行的電影《特洛伊》改編自荷馬的史詩《伊利亞德》，該史詩描述了長達十年的特洛伊戰爭最後幾週的活動。戰爭圍繞著世界上最美麗的女性——斯巴達的海倫展開。在帕里斯的評判事件後，阿芙蘿黛蒂女神履行了她的諾言，讓海倫愛上帕里斯並與他私奔。為海倫的離開而憤怒的斯巴達國王墨涅拉俄斯與他的哥哥邁錫尼國王阿加曼農結盟。他們承諾要奪回海倫，最終集結了阿開亞軍隊入侵特洛伊。電影以特洛伊的陷落和為阿基里斯（布萊德·彼特飾）舉行的葬禮告終。

BBC Comedy: Yes Minister / BBC 喜劇：《是，大臣》

Yes Minister, a British political satire sitcom, was first broadcasted on BBC 2 from 1980 to 1984. The context was set in the private office of a British cabinet minister in the fictional Department of Administrative Affairs in Whitehall. Jim Hacker was the British Minister for Administrative Affairs, being responsible for policy development. As a Permanent Secretary of the Department, Sir Humphrey Appleby should support and give assistance to the Minister. As a senior public servant, Humphrey fully understood how government works and what kind of policy had good/bad influence on government or even on the Minister's political career. In addition, the Principal Private Secretary Bernard Woolley always played a role in coordinating between political master and civil service boss. In short, the comedy centered around interaction among the three.

《是，大臣》是一部英國政治諷刺情境喜劇，於 1980 年至 1984 年在 BBC 2 首次播出。故事背景設定在 Whitehall 虛構的行政事務部的一位英國內閣大臣的私人辦公室。吉姆·哈克是英國行政事務部大臣，負責政策制定。作為該部門的常務秘書，漢弗萊·阿普比爵士應該支持並為大臣提供協助。作為一名高級公務員，漢弗萊完全理解政府是如何運作的，以及什麼樣的政策對政府甚至對大臣的政治生涯有好的/壞的影響。此外，首席私人秘書伯納德·伍利總是在政治首腦和公務員首腦之間發揮協調作用。簡而言之，這部喜劇圍繞著這三者之間的互動展開。

There was a plot quoting the phrases "Trojan horse" and "beware of Greeks bearing gifts" in season 3 episode 5, The Bed of Nails, in which Jim had been offered a job working on Transport issues and Sir Humphrey was explaining to him why it was a terrible idea.

在第三季第五集《釘子床》中，有一個情節引用了「特洛伊木馬」和「小心帶來禮物的希臘人」這兩個片語，劇中吉姆被提供了一份負責運輸問題的工作，而漢弗萊爵士正在向他解釋為什麼這是一個糟糕透頂的主意。